上海交通大學
SHANGHAI JIAO TONG UNIVERSITY

TC3000J
Technical Communication

Public Speaking

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Public Speaking

Categories of Talks

Report Type of Talk

E.g. For presenting conference papers. Presenting a proposal/technical solutions.

Begin with background, problem you're addressing, how it is tied to previous research/experience. State results without going too much into the detail, or at least selective detail.

Interview Talk

For job or professional interviews.

Focus on a specific topic, aiming your talk at mid-level professionals, but prepared to discuss simpler or more advanced concepts. If you do not know an answer, say you are still researching it, or redirect to a topic you know.

Types of Speeches

Delivery Method	Main uses	Main Drawbacks
IMPROMPTU (inventing as you speak)	• In-house meetings • Small, intimate groups • Simple topics	• Offers no chance to prepare • Speaker might ramble • Speaker might lose track
SCRIPTED (reading verbatim from a written work)	• Formal speeches • Large, unfamiliar groups • Strict time limit • Cross-cultural audiences • To assist highly nervous speakers	• Takes a long time to prepare • Speaker can't move around • Limits interaction • Can appear stiff and unnatural • Might bore listeners • Makes working with visuals difficult
EXTEMPORANEOUS (speaking from an outline of key points)	• Face-to-face presentations • Medium-sized, familiar groups • Moderately complex topics • Somewhat flexible time limit • Visually based presentations	• Speaker might lose track • Speaker might leave something out • Speaker might get tongue-tied • Speaker might exceed time limit • Speaker might fumble with notes, visuals, or equipment

Lannon & Gurak (2018)

Speaking Purposes

Inform	Describe objective facts, cite specific sources of information
Instruct	List out learning outcomes at the start, provide instructions that audience take away
Persuade	Describe what the situation is first, then explain how your proposition is the best way to answer to it
Call to action	Explain why other options are not feasible, use strong action words for what should be done
Sell an idea	Address the problem, then explain how your idea is the solution to it

Analyse Your Situation

What is your presentation goal?

What is the scenario?

Who is your audience?

What would be the appropriate contents?

Audience

- Colleagues
- Clients
- Fellow engineers
- Government officials
- General Public

Analyse Your Audience

Who will be there?	What do they know about the project? What do they need to be brought up to speed on?	What values do they have? Where will they agree with you? Where will they disagree with you?
What do they expect to get out of this presentation?	What stories and examples would speak to them?	Will they need to use this information to vote on or select something?

Core Skills for Presenting

Content and Structure

Body Language

Intonation

Group Interaction

Content and Structure

- Opening hook: quote, story, or rhetorical question
- Core value
- Body: supporting arguments or narratives
- Tying arguments/narratives back to the main theme
- Ending with a call to action

How to plan a presentation?

Example: Presentation about a new greenway project by the developer.

1. Introduction
   a. Project need & background
   b. Team working on the project & our experience
2. Goals of greenway
   a. Recreation goals
   b. City council goals
3. Project details
   a. Length of trail
   b. Trail access points, trailheads, and corresponding parking lots

https://d3n8a8pro7vhmx.cloudfront.net/mplsbike/pages/3445/attachments/original/1459887460/NMpls_Greenway.jpg?1459887460
NC State University, Technical Communication Videos, https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLR-UWtI0r_GDI8SOgsyTR4rmW_gtprqB6

Why don't you love this slide? It's so informative!

Do you really want to read this much text on a slide?

Is your audience really listening to you when you use this many bullet points?

Is your audience even looking at you when you make them read all of this?

Are *you* even looking at the audience if you are turned to the slide and reading all the text you wrote?

Your more likely to habe more typos with moore text. Yikes!

Slides are for support, not to substitute you

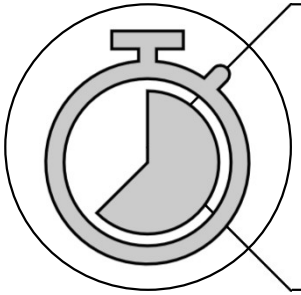
Your audience likely has the report or other content from you they can read. They want to hear you speak and be engaged!

This is why you must practice and memorize: Then you can speak without the "notes" on the slides!

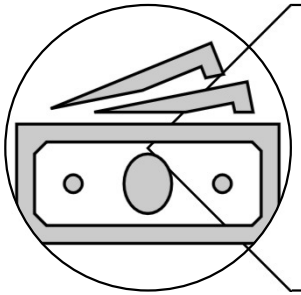
General Tips for Slide Design

- One slide = One idea
- Use consistent slide design
- Use a meaningful slide title
- Use a non-serif font (Arial, Calibri, Aptos) No Comic Sans!
- A picture says more than a thousand words

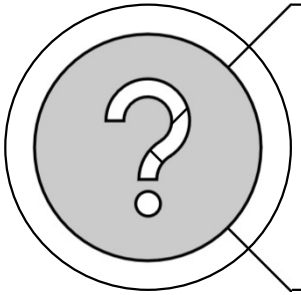
The Final Slide



The final slide is the longest exposed slide
Q&A sessions usually last around 10-20 min



The final slide is very expensive!
How much does a 5 min TV advertisement spot cost?



If your audience cannot see what you put on the slide, it is as good as not showing them anything.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iq8ZcZJc15U

Thank you for your attention!

Outdated

Body Language

- Posture
- Hand and eye motions
- Moving around the stage

Intonation

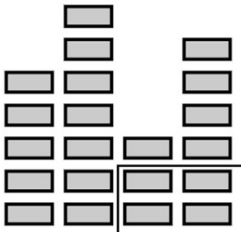
- Extended pauses
- One word “punch”
- Suspense and release
- Changing the voices
- Varying sentence lengths

Microphone Etiquette

Distance

Breathing

Swallowing



Background

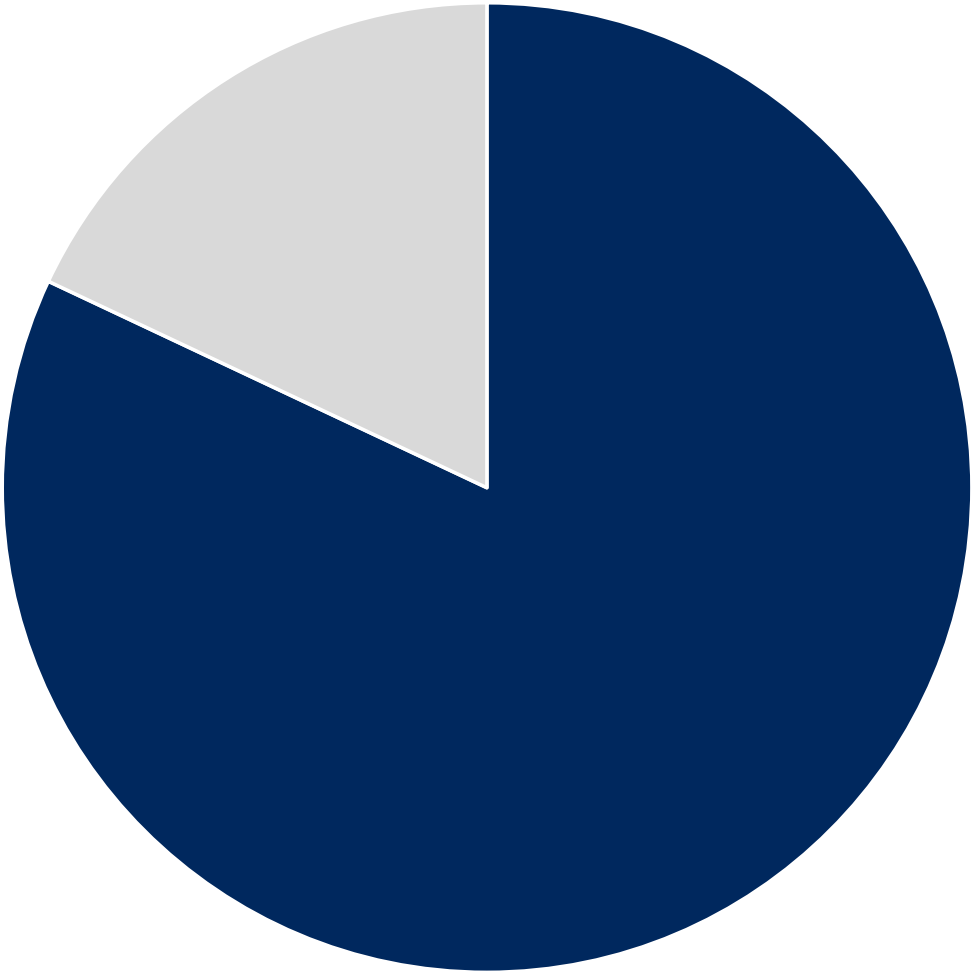
Noises

Feedback

Audience Interaction

- Ask rhetorical questions
- Refer to people, not abstractions
- Provide handouts and graphic organizers
- Give numbers in advance for listeners to anticipate
- Use hand gestures and body motions to dissipate nerves
- Use pauses and controlled pacing to eliminate involuntary *ah*'s and *umm*'s

Why is Public Speaking Important?



82%

of engineers deliver between

1-5

presentations per week

University of Michigan Engineering 2019
NC State University, Technical Communication Videos, https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLR-UWtI0r_GDI8SOgsyTR4rmW_gtprqB6

Presentation Workload

What we see in a presentation

20 minutes

What we don’t see (Preparation)

6-12 hours

NC State University, Technical Communication Videos, https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLR-UWtI0r_GDI8SOgsyTR4rmW_gtprqB6

Strategies to Improve

- Proper slide design, especially content and visual – Plan
- Rehearsing for the flow of ideas – Revise
- Record or do it with your group with timing – Polish
- Avoid memorizing the script word-by-word – Interact and Naturalize
- Get comfortable and confident

Practice is the key!

In-class Activities

- Prepare your final presentation in your group!
- If help needed, please come to talk to the teaching team!
- Your talks in the practice time will be recorded.